

18.7 Summary and Notes

18.7.1 Summary

Idea.

1. Analysis of covariance is a projection problem. With design part $\mathbf{X}$ (any rank) and covariates $\mathbf{Z}$, the model space splits orthogonally as $\mathcal{C}(\mathbf{X}) \oplus \mathcal{C}((\mathbf{I} - \mathbf{M})\mathbf{Z})$. The covariate coefficients are estimated from within-group variation, $\hat{\boldsymbol{\gamma}} = \mathbf{E}_{zz}^{-1} \mathbf{E}_{zy}$, and the design part is fitted to the adjusted response $\mathbf{y} - \mathbf{Z}\hat{\boldsymbol{\gamma}}$. Tests compare residual sums of squares of nested models (Theorem 18.1.1).
2. In a randomized experiment a covariate measured before randomization reduces the variance of treatment comparisons by the factor $(1 - \rho^2)\{1 + 1/(N - g - 2)\}$ (Proposition 18.1.2), and it removes the conditional bias caused by chance imbalance (Section 18.1). A covariate affected by the treatment must not be adjusted for (same section).
3. Adjusted means are estimable functions $\mu_k + \mathbf{z}_0^\top \boldsymbol{\gamma}$, estimated by $\bar{y}_k - (\bar{\mathbf{z}}_k - \mathbf{z}_0)^\top \hat{\boldsymbol{\gamma}}$. They are correlated, their variances grow with the distance of $\bar{\mathbf{z}}_k$ from $\mathbf{z}_0$, and their differences do not depend on $\mathbf{z}_0$ (Definition 18.2.1 and Proposition 18.2.1). Scheffé's intervals are exact for all their contrasts; Tukey-type intervals are approximate.
4. The test of parallel slopes is a weighted test of homogeneity of the within-group slopes (Theorem 18.3.1). When slopes differ, the treatment difference is a line in the covariate, to be reported with a band or a Johnson–Neyman region (Proposition 18.3.2).
5. In a randomized complete block design, block effects cancel from every treatment contrast. The analysis is the additive two-way analysis (Theorem 18.4.1). Randomization alone makes the contrast estimates unbiased and the error mean square unbiased for their variance (Proposition 18.4.2). The block experiment estimates the error variance a completely randomized design would have had (Proposition 18.4.4).
6. A Latin square blocks in two crossed directions with mutually orthogonal row, column and treatment spaces. Its error consists of confounded interaction pieces (Theorem 18.5.1).
7. A balanced incomplete block design has information matrix $(\lambda t/k)(\mathbf{I} - \mathbf{J}/t)$. Contrasts are estimated from the adjusted totals Q_i with variance $(k/\lambda t)\sigma^2 \sum c_i^2$, and the efficiency factor relative to complete blocks is $\lambda t/(rk)$ (Theorem 18.5.3).
8. A lost observation is handled exactly by least squares on the remaining data. Filling it with its fitted value, found by Yates's formula, by iteration or by the covariate method, reproduces the exact estimates and residual sum of squares. The error degrees of freedom must be reduced, and tests must be computed by comparing models (Theorem 18.6.1 and Corollary 18.6.2).

18.7.2 Notes and sources

Analysis of covariance. Fisher introduced the analysis of covariance in the 1930s, in later editions of *Statistical Methods for Research Workers* (Fisher 1925 and later editions), as a

way of using a concomitant measurement to increase the precision of agricultural experiments. Cochran's review (Cochran 1957) remains an excellent account of its uses, including the dangers of adjusting for a covariate affected by treatment and of adjusting non-randomized groups. Rencher and Schaalje (2008, chapter 16) treat one-way, two-way and multi-covariate layouts and the test of homogeneous slopes. Christensen (2020, chapter 9) derives the analysis through the projection $(\mathbf{I} - \mathbf{M})\mathbf{Z}$, which is the route taken in Theorem 18.1.1, and uses the same device for missing data and for incomplete block designs. The case against testing baseline balance in randomized trials was made forcefully by Senn (1994). The modern debate on regression adjustment in randomized experiments, which asks whether adjustment can hurt when the model is wrong, was opened by Freedman (2008) and answered, for the interacted estimator of Exercise (C1), by Lin (2013). [Chapter 25](#) returns to it (Theorem 25.6.2).

Heterogeneous slopes. The region of significance for non-parallel lines is due to Johnson and Neyman (1936), who developed it for comparisons of teaching methods with an ability covariate. Simultaneous versions use the Scheffé argument of [Chapter 13](#).

Block designs and randomization. Randomization, blocking and the Latin square as a design are Fisher's, set out in *The Design of Experiments* (Fisher 1935). The randomization moments of Proposition 18.4.2 and the view of the linear model as an approximation justified by randomization are developed in Kempthorne (1952) and Hinkelmann and Kempthorne (2008). Cox (1958) remains the best short account of the ideas behind designed experiments, and Bailey (2008) gives a modern treatment of block designs built on the same orthogonal decompositions as this chapter. Relative efficiencies such as Eq. 18.4.2 are standard in the design literature, for instance Cochran and Cox (1957). Christensen (2020, chapter 8) presents the randomized complete block and Latin square models as additive multi-way layouts and discusses their assumptions.

Incomplete blocks. Balanced incomplete block designs were introduced by Yates (1936), who also showed how to recover inter-block information (Yates 1940). Fisher (1940) proved the inequality $b \geq t$ of Lemma 18.5.2. Christensen (2020, section 9.4) derives the intra-block analysis as an analysis of covariance with the treatment indicators as covariates, as in the proof of Theorem 18.5.3.

Missing values. Yates (1933) derived the missing value formula Eq. 18.6.3 and the rule of subtracting a degree of freedom for each estimated value. Bartlett (1937) proposed the covariance method with indicator covariates, and Healy and Westmacott (1956) the iterative method of Theorem 18.6.1(c), convenient for early computers. Dempster, Laird and Rubin (1977) placed the iteration within the EM algorithm. Christensen (2020, section 9.3) treats missing observations through the covariance model.

18.7.3 References

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